Managing Individuals

(Chapter 2 of textbook)

Access to e-learning

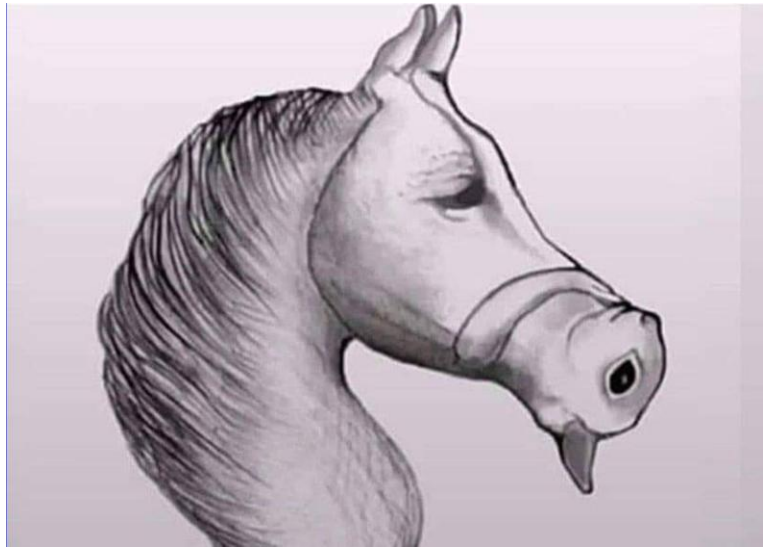
Enroll: ICMB235 Management Organisation Behaviour (Aj.Saifon)

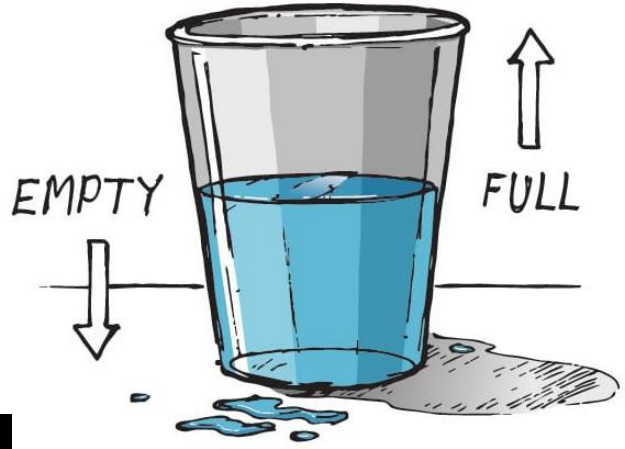
Trimester 2.2025

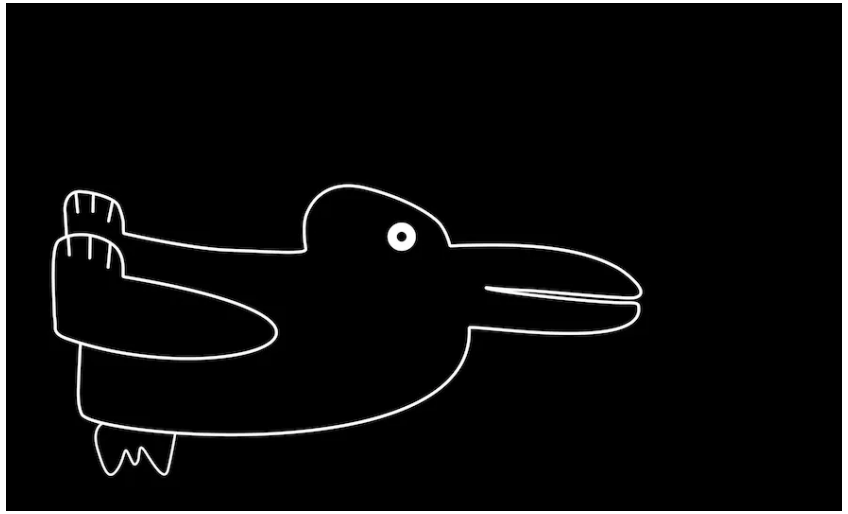
Perception

The process of receiving, attending to, processing, storing and using stimuli to understand and make sense of our world

Perception

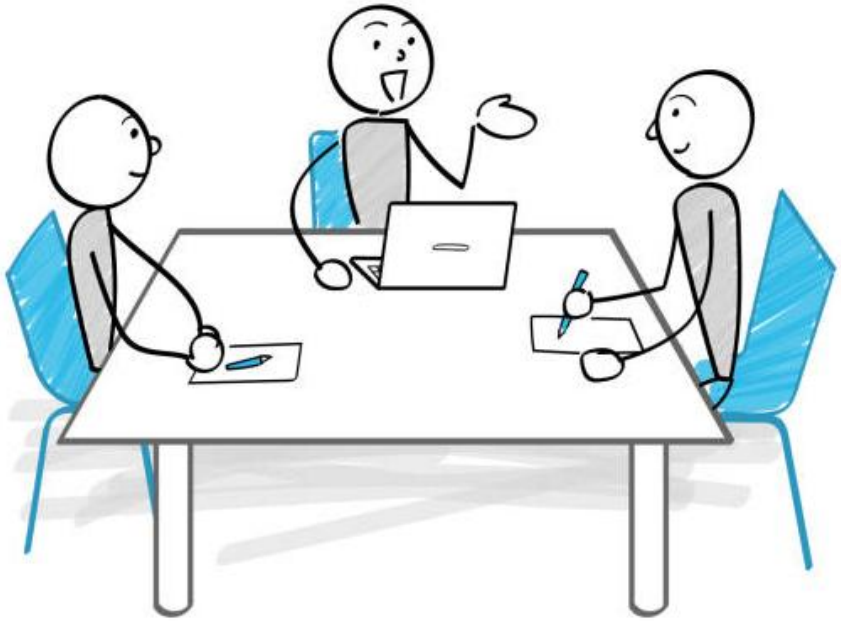






What affects our perception?

Perception at Work

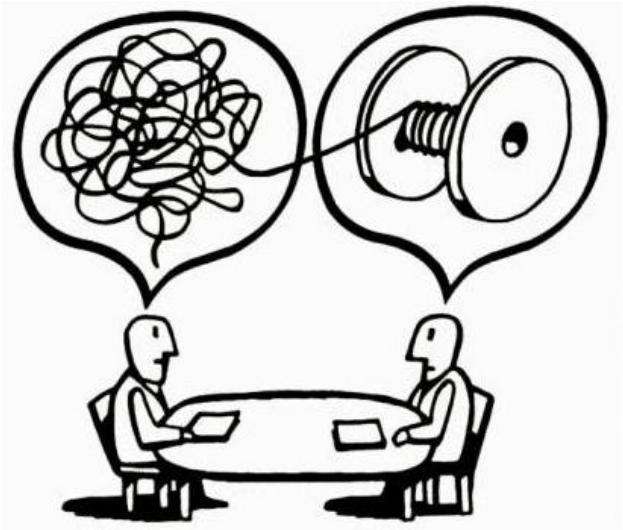


- **Marketer**
- **Engineer**
- **Financier**

Schemas

- Current knowledge about someone or something
- "*mental shortcuts*" or "*folders in the brain*"

Sensemaking



Perception at Work

- **Types of schemas**
  1. Person schemas
  2. Self-schemas
  3. Script schemas
  4. Role schemas

Types of Schemas

- **Person schemas**
  - Structures of meaning that affect thinking, planning and behavior concerning **others**
- **Self-schemas**
  - Specific self-conception we hold about **ourselves**
  - Reflect how we expect ourselves to think, feel and act in specific settings or situations

Person Schema (*about others*)

You believe your colleague Anna is ambitious and detail-oriented. So, when assigned a group project, you assume she'll take the lead and deliver high-quality work.

Person Schema (*about others*)

Anna has just started a new job at a marketing firm. On her first day, she meets her new manager, James. As soon as she sees him wearing a suit, speaking confidently, and giving clear instructions, she immediately categorizes him as "a professional and competent leader.“

Self Schema (*about self*)

Samantha has always thought of herself as a shy and introverted person. Throughout high school, she avoided large social gatherings and felt more comfortable working alone.

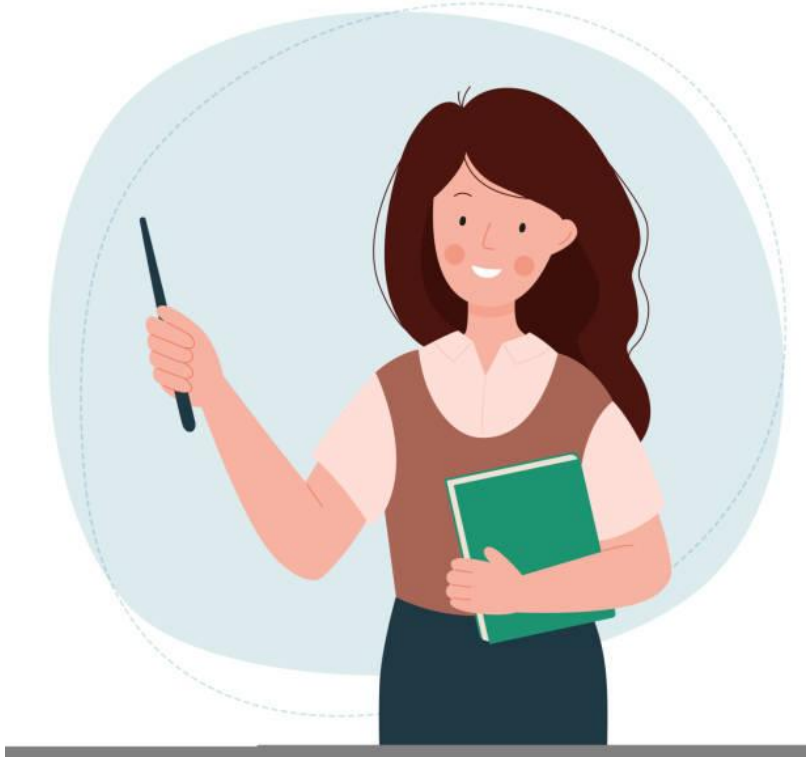
Script Schemas

Schemas about how we operate in our world and understand and remember information

Script Schemas

Role Schemas

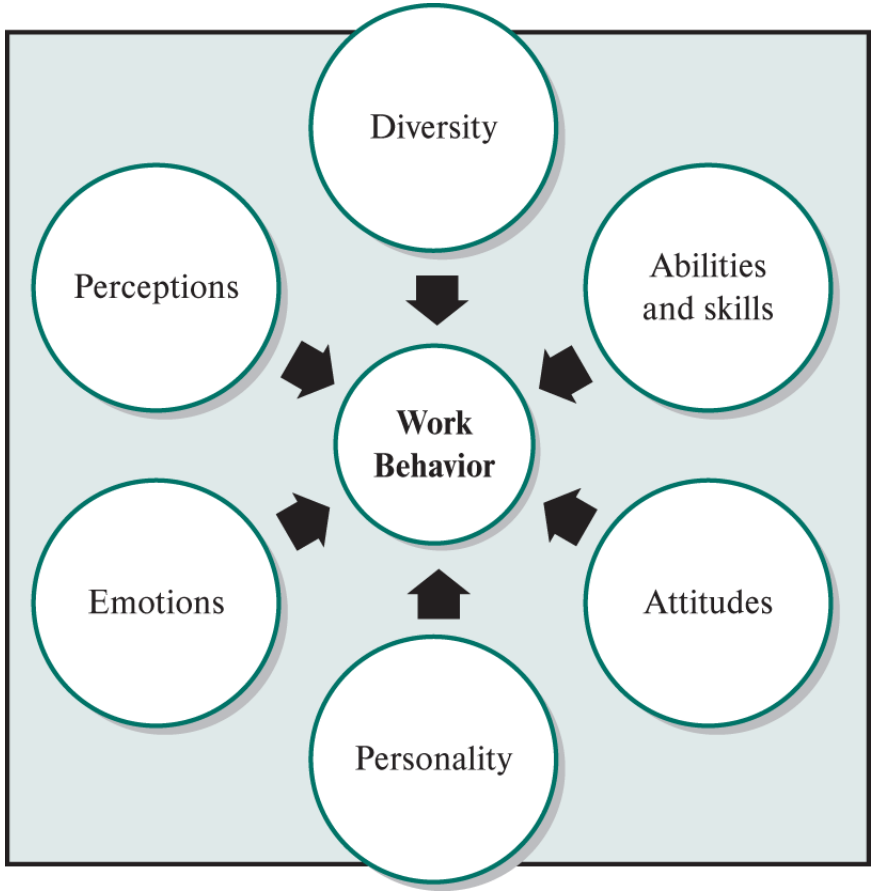
Schemas about appropriate and inappropriate behavior in specific contexts



Why Individual Differences Matter

- Effective managerial practice requires that individual behavior differences be recognized.
- Ability to observe differences, understand relationships, and predict linkages can facilitate managerial attempts to improve performance.

Individual Differences Influences Work Behavior

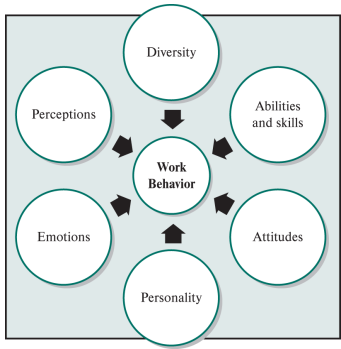


Diversity

Attributes that make people different from one another

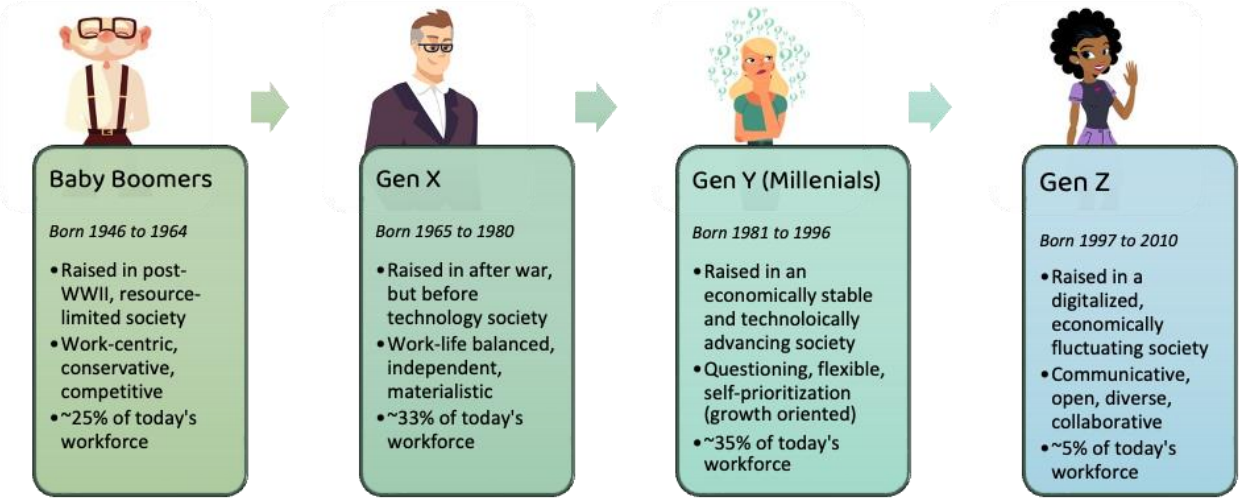
Primary (and stable) dimensions:

Secondary (and changeable) dimensions:

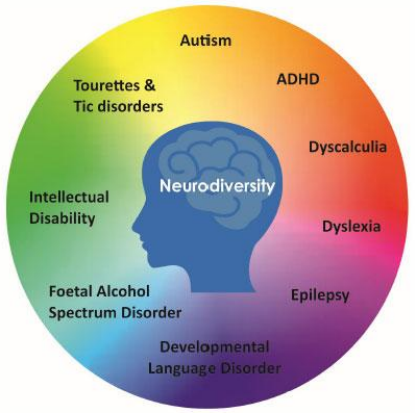


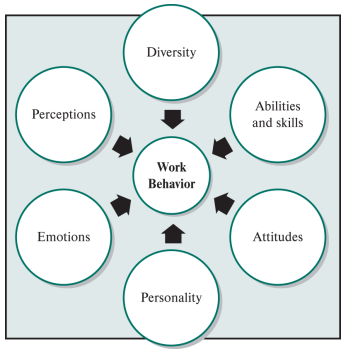
Diversity

Generational diversity



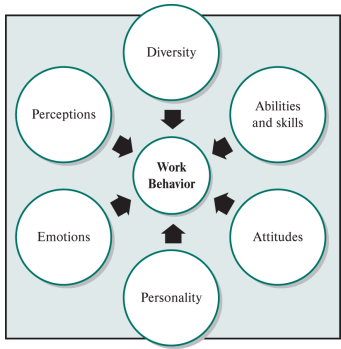
Disability diversity





Abilities and Skills

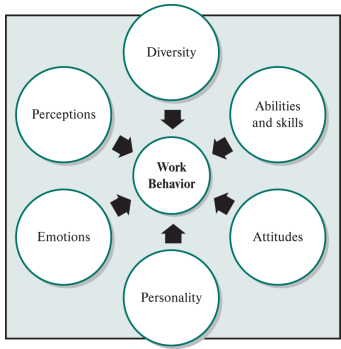
- **Ability**
  - A person's talent to perform a mental or physical task
  - Generally stable over time
  - Mental ability (also *intelligence*)



Abilities and Skills

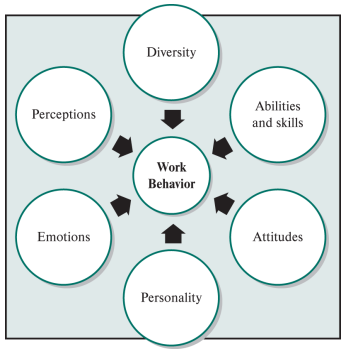
- **Skills**
  - **Learned** talent that a person has acquired to perform a task
  - Change as one's training or experience occurs

- **Tacit knowledge:** work-related practical know-how that employees acquire through **observation** and **direct experience**.
    - E.g., problem solving, leadership skills

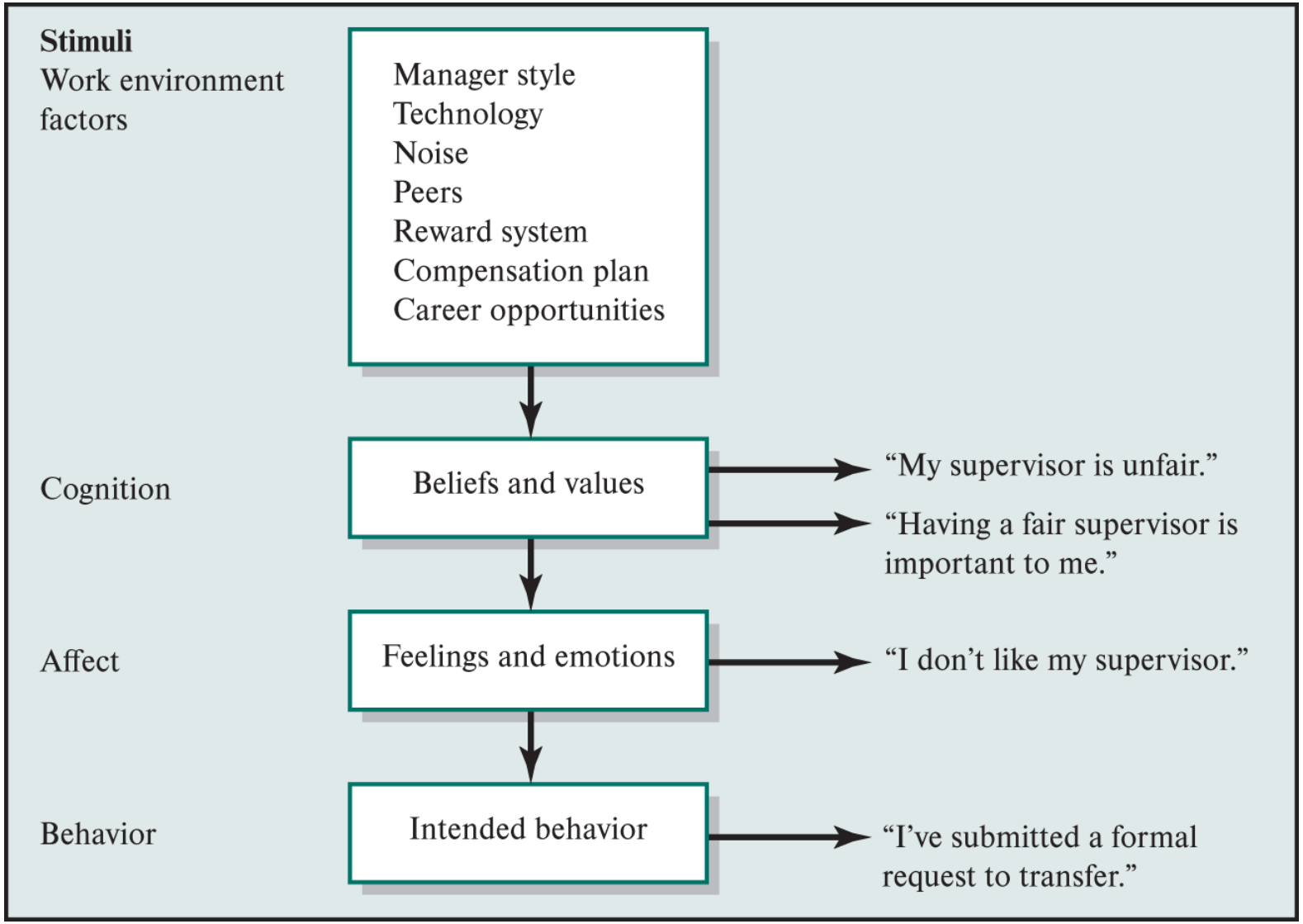


Attitudes

- A mental state of readiness learned and organized **through experience**
- **Components of attitudes:**
  1. **Cognition**
     – conscious process of acquiring **knowledge**
     – consist of person's perceptions, opinions and beliefs
  2. **Affect**
     – **emotional** component of attitude
     – "feeling" a certain way about a person, group or situation
  3. **Behavior**
     – tendency of a person to **act** in a certain way toward someone or something



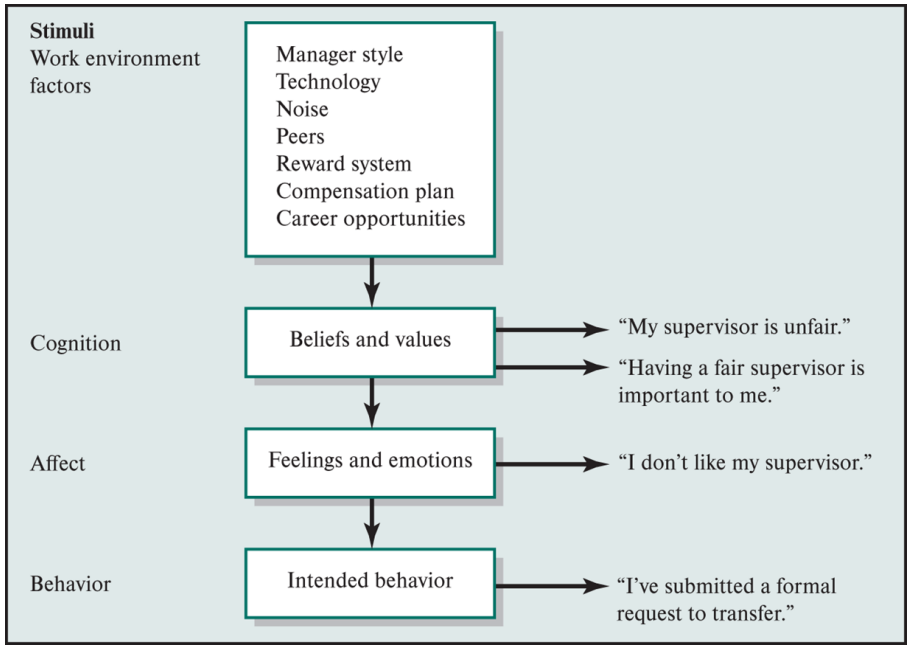
The Three Components of Attitudes



Attitude Towards Work

Beliefs & Values

- Work is an opportunity for growth and personal achievement.
- Challenges are learning experiences

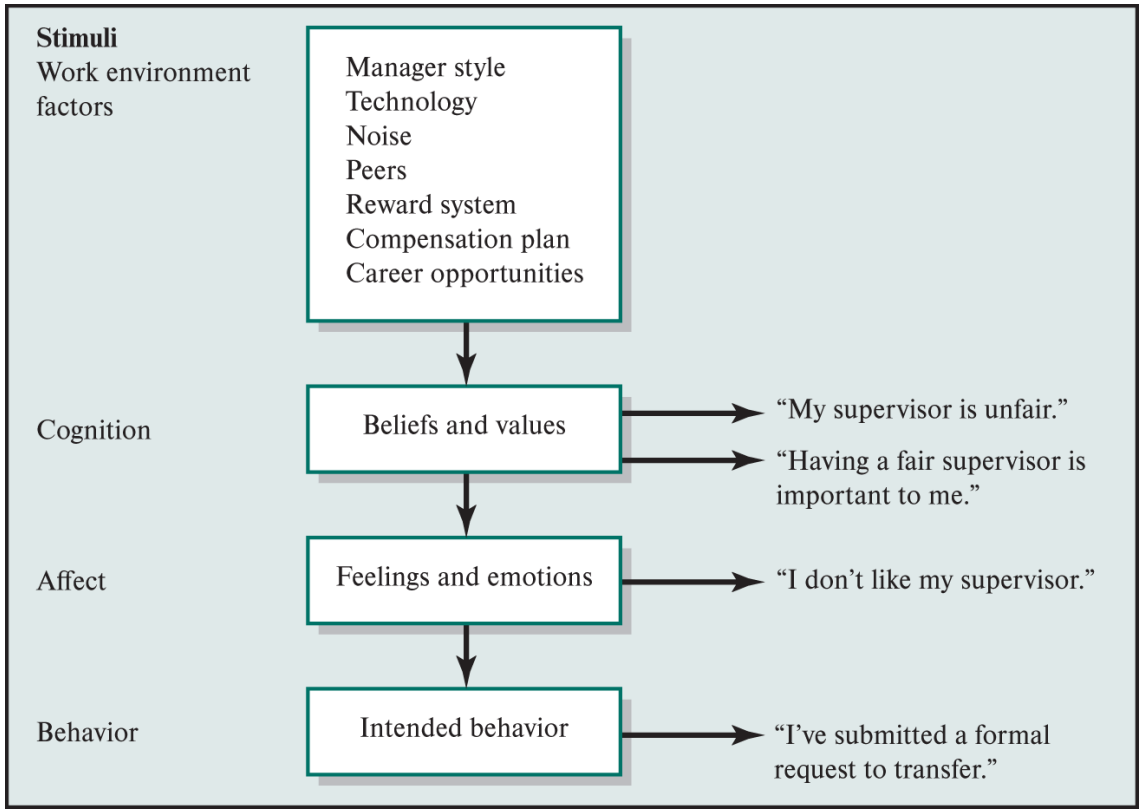


Beliefs & Values

- Work is just a way to get a paycheck.
- Lacks motivation and finds his tasks boring.

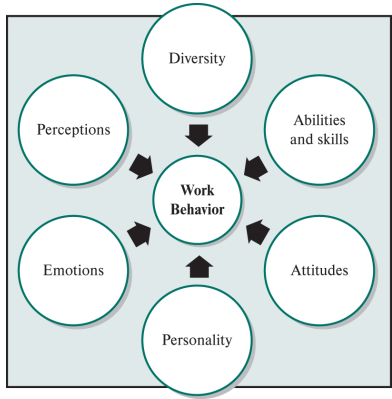
Attitudes

Implication for managers?



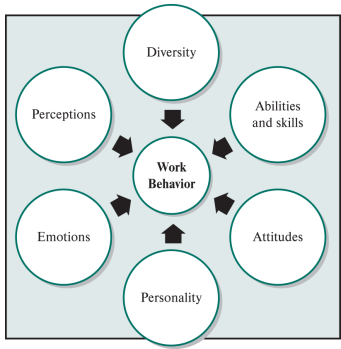
Personality

- A relatively stable set of feelings and behaviors that have been significantly formed by genetic and environmental factors
- Personality influences work behaviors such as job performance, training proficiency, and job satisfaction
- Myer-Briggs Type Inventory (MBTI): 16 Personality Types
- **Personality dimensions:**
  - The Big Five Personality dimensions
  - Locus of control
  - Self-efficacy
  - Creativity



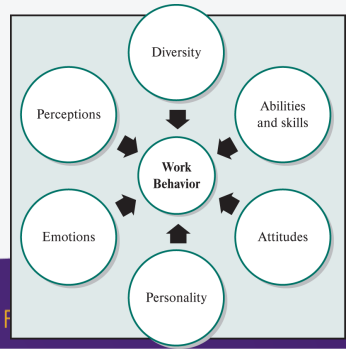
Personality: The Big Five Personality Dimensions

- Extroversion
  - The tendency to be sociable, gregarious, assertive, talkative, and active
  - Tend to:
    - perform well in sales and managerial jobs
    - do better in training programs



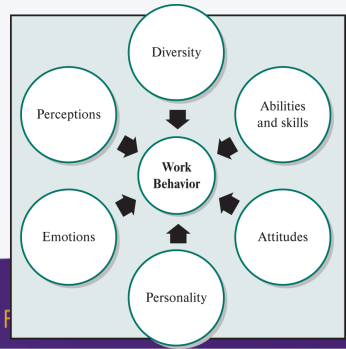
The Big Five Personality Dimensions

- Emotional stability
  - Tendency to experience positive emotions states, such as feeling psychologically secure, calm, and relaxed
  - Tend to have high motivation and overall job satisfaction



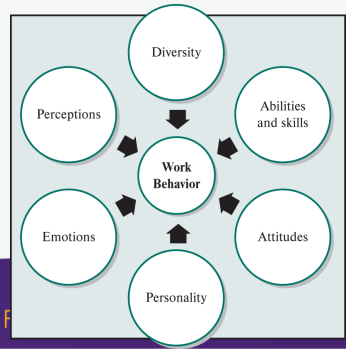
The Big Five Personality Dimensions

- Agreeableness
  - Tendency to be courteous, forgiving, tolerant, trusting, and softhearted
  - Tend to:
    - be an effective team player
    - interpersonal skills



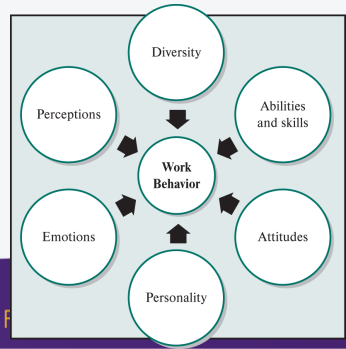
The Big Five Personality Dimensions

- Conscientiousness
  - Tendency to be dependable, organized, thorough, and responsible
  - Persevere, work hard, enjoy achieving and accomplishing things
  - Perform better across a wide variety of occupations



The Big Five Personality Dimensions

- Openness to experience
  - Extent to which an individual is broad-minded, creative, curious, and intelligent
  - Has broad interests & willing to take risks
  - Thrive in occupations where change is continuous and where innovation is critical



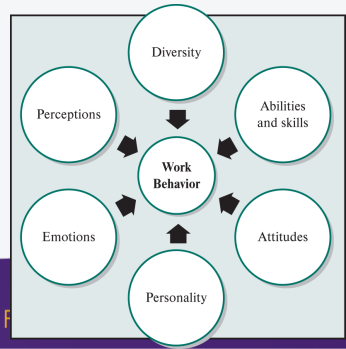
Example

A manager gives strong negative feedback to an employee

- ✓ Extroversion
- ✓ Emotional stability
- ✓ Agreeableness
- ✓ Conscientiousness
- ✓ Openness to experience

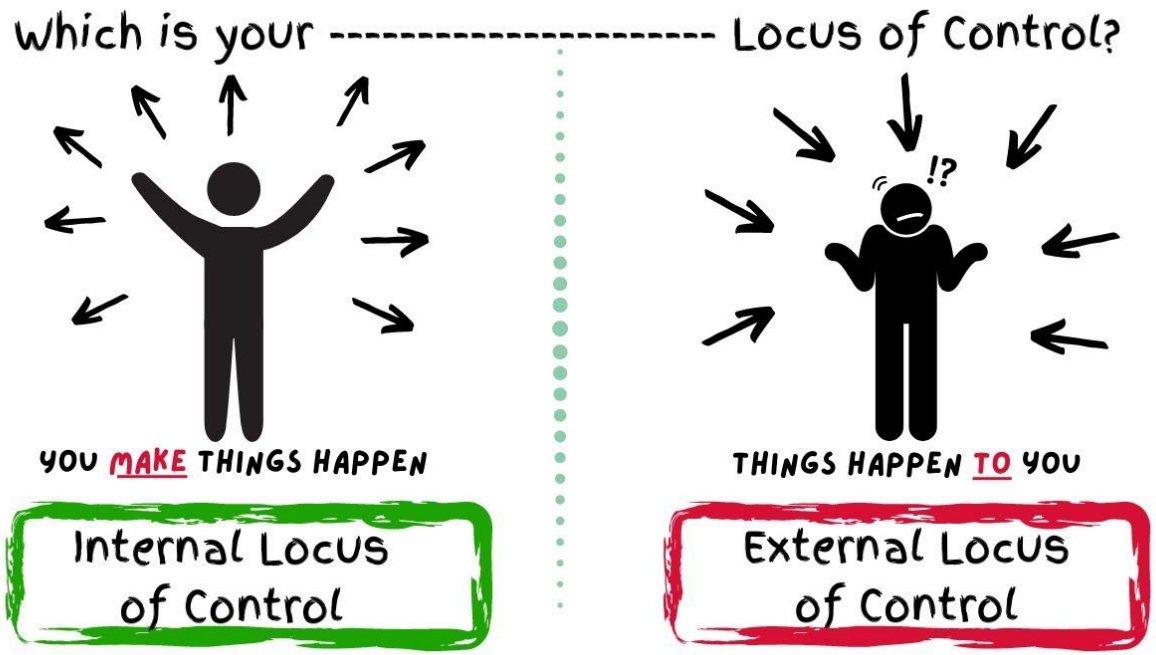
Personality: Locus of Control

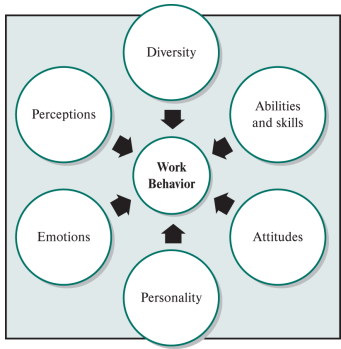
- A person's belief that he/she does or does not master his/her fate
- Internals:
  - masters of their own fate
  - have personal responsibility for what happens to them
- Externals:
  - controlled by outside forces over which they have little, if any, influence
  - when they perform well, they believe it is due to luck
- In organizational settings, internals usually do not require as much supervision as do externals



Locus of Control

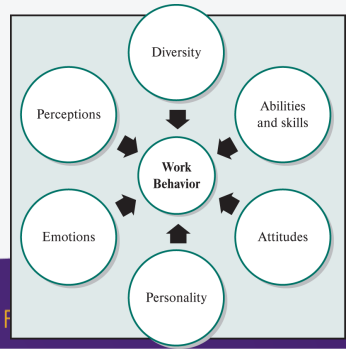
Implication for managers?





Personality: Self-Efficacy

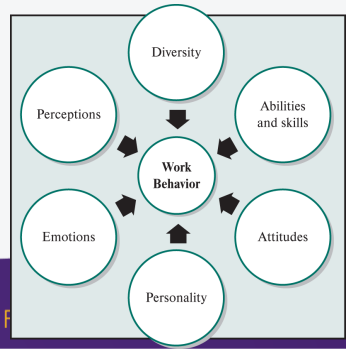
- A person's belief that he/she has the competency to complete a job successfully
- Developed from **past experience** (i.e., past success → increased confidence)



Personality: Creativity

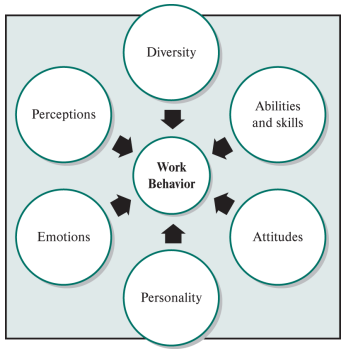
- The ability to break away from habit-bound thinking and produce novel and useful ideas

Creativity can be encouraged. How?



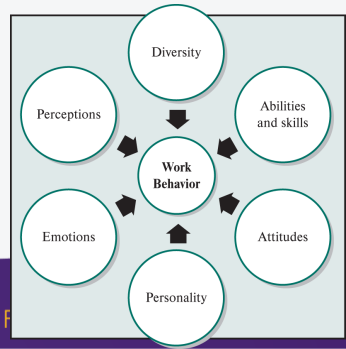
Emotions

- A state of physiological arousal accompanied by changes in facial expressions, gestures, posture, or subject feelings
- Emotional contagion
  - automatic transfer of mood or emotions from one individual to others



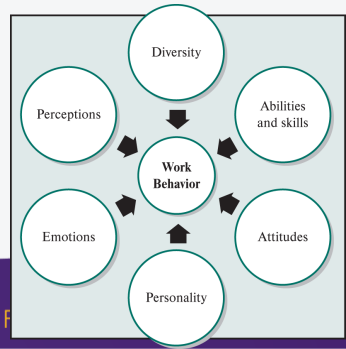
Emotions

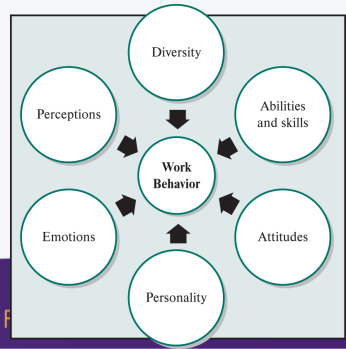
- Emotional intelligence (EI)
  - the ability to manage one's own and others' emotions in order to guide one's behavior and achieve goals
  - affects social relations, workplace performance, mental and physical well-being
  - **4 dimensions:**
    1. Self-awareness
    2. Self-management
    3. Social awareness
    4. Relationship management



Emotional Intelligence (EI)

- **Self-awareness**
  - awareness of own emotions and feelings
  - better position to act in a way that fits with their emotions
- **Self-management**
  - not letting emotions or mood swings disrupt productivity or relationships with others
  - self-control helps maintain a reputation for being adaptable, trustworthy, and good under pressure



Emotional Intelligence (EI)

- **Social awareness**
  - demonstrate empathy or relating to other people
  - more likely to meet other's needs and understand the needs of the organization
- **Relationship management**
  - maintaining positive and productive relationships with people at work
  - listen to others' needs, communicate in a positive manner, collaborate with them on projects, support their ideas and initiatives